# Amy Kim

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| **Placement Director** | Gianluca Violante | violante@princeton.edu | 609-258-4003 |
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## EDUCATION

**Princeton University,** Princeton — Expected **May 2027**

Ph.D. Candidate, Economics

**References**

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Professor Ilyana Kuziemko | Professor Leah Boustan | Professor David Lee |
| Department of Economics | Department of Economics | Department of Economics |
| Princeton University | Yale University | Princeton University |
| kuziemko@princeton.edu | leah.boustan@yale.edu | davidlee@princeton.edu |

**Massachusetts Institute of Technology,** Cambridge — **January 2021**

B.S. Computer Science & Mathematics; Economics

## FIELDS

Labor Economics, Migration, Applied Microeconomics

## JOB MARKET PAPER

**"International Students and the U.S. Skilled Workforce: Evidence from Optional Practical Training"**

Optional Practical Training (OPT), which allows international students to work in the U.S. temporarily after graduation, has become an increasingly important point of entry into the skilled labor market for foreign workers. Evidence on its labor market effects is limited, partly because graduates' OPT usage is difficult to link to their U.S. employment. In this paper, I use novel imputed individual-level linkages between administrative immigration records and graduates' employment histories to study how OPT has impacted the skilled workforce. I first study graduates themselves, using a difference-in-differences design based on universities' reclassification of degree programs, which makes graduates eligible for a two-year extension to OPT. I estimate that 27% of OPT work added by access to the extension would otherwise have occurred through other immigration routes. On net, access to the extension increases graduates' U.S. employment by 35% over their first three years post-graduation, with smaller effects on longer-term employment. I next study firms, using variation in their exposure to expansions of extension-eligible programs at schools where they have historically hired. More-exposed firms hire more OPT workers, with no detectable decline in their employment of other workers. Applied to a recently proposed OPT fee, my estimates imply that under a wide range of scenarios the fee would substantially shrink the skilled workforce.

## PUBLICATIONS

1. **"The Effects of Prohibiting Marriage Bars: The Case of U.S. Teachers"** with Carolyn Tsao, *The Journal of Economic History* [forthcoming].
    - Winner of the 2024 IPUMS USA Research Award

## WORKING PAPERS

1. **"Evaluating the Consequences of High Migration Costs: Evidence from the 1885 Chinese Head Tax"**

2. **"Staying Power: The Individual Effects of the H-1B Visa Lottery"**

## PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

**Presentations and Seminars**

2026 Princeton University, Midwestern Economics Association Annual Conference
2025 Migrations and Organizations Ph.D. Consortium
2024 McMaster University

**Refereeing**

American Economic Journal: Applied Microeconomics, Journal of Economic History

## TEACHING

**Quantitative Analysis for Policymakers (SPI 507A),** Princeton **Fall 2024**
**Introduction to Machine Learning (6.036 LA),** MIT **Spring 2020**
**Fundamentals of Programming (6.009 LA),** MIT **Fall 2018**

## MAJOR HONORS, AWARDS & GRANTS

**National Science Foundation** Graduate Research Fellowship **2021– 2026**
**IPUMS USA** Award for Best Student Research **2024**
**Program for Research on Inequality** Grant Recipient **2023**
**Louis A. Simpson** *60 P90 Graduate Fellowship **2022**
**Phi Beta Kappa** Society Inductee **2021**

## OTHER

**Native Speaker of** English; **Heritage Speaker of** Korean; **Intermediate** French
**Citizen of** Canada and USA